Ahmet Samet Yüzlü

Technical Lead & Software Architect | Node.js, TypeScript, React, AWS | Secure SDLC (ISO 27001, SOC 2), AI-first engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack engineer and technical lead with 15+ years of building and running production applications, remote since 2013. I wrote the first version of the Mall IQ platform backend and have led its engineering since 2019, working directly with the CEO; the platform serves millions of users, with the busiest single server peaking at 1,500 requests per second. I own delivery end to end: Node.js/TypeScript backends, React and Angular frontends, AWS, GitHub Actions CI/CD, observability and incident response. Security is part of my daily work: GitHub Advanced Security, penetration-test remediation, Keycloak SSO and contributions to ISO 27001 and SOC 2 certification; I am also building Openasy, an open-source security platform. I moved my team to AI-first engineering with Claude Code and lead a team of up to five engineers. At YouReply I built regulated money flows (payments to research participants, national-ID verification).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead — Mall IQ, Inc.
Sep 2019 – Present | Remote, US-based location-intelligence and marketing platform

- Lead a team of up to 5 engineers and own architecture, code review standards and delivery for the core platform; grew developers on the team into senior engineers.
- Own the full stack (Node.js/TypeScript, MySQL, Angular/React) of a platform serving millions of users, with the busiest single server peaking at 1,500 requests per second across a 40+ server fleet.
- Integrated OpenAI APIs into client dashboards to automate campaign creation and audience segmentation; leading new AI-driven product features.
- Moved the team to AI-first engineering, from GitHub Copilot to Claude, for day-to-day development.
- Built and maintain bidirectional partner integrations: versioned REST APIs plus outbound webhooks that notify partners when a user qualifies for a campaign.
- Reliability and observability: MySQL replication and read replicas, Redis caching, load and performance testing, Prometheus/Grafana monitoring, on-call incident response (Opsgenie, later an in-house tool).
- Introduced CI/CD (GitHub Actions), automated testing (Jest, Mocha, Cypress), monitoring and vulnerability scanning.
- Secure SDLC: GitHub Advanced Security (dependency, code and secret scanning), penetration-test remediation, Keycloak for enterprise IAM and SSO (OAuth2, SAML); contributed to ISO 27001 and SOC 2 certification and authored security documentation.
- Modernised the stack in place (Node.js 16→24, Angular 10→19, Debian 8/9/10→13.7) and led modularisation and technical-debt reduction.

Full Stack Software Engineer — Mall IQ, Inc.
Sep 2016 – Sep 2019

- Wrote the first version of the Mall IQ platform backend, which today serves millions of users worldwide.
- Built backend APIs and customer-facing dashboards for campaigns, segmentation, reporting, audit/history and administration.
- Integrated Apache Airflow to orchestrate automated data and processing workflows; deployed and maintained 40+ servers and clusters.

Co-founder & CTO — YouReply
Mar 2023 – Present | Part-time | Crowdsourced academic research platform

- Lead all technology; designed and hand-built the backend in TypeScript and Python.
- Built the payment flows from researchers to participants and identity verification against Turkish national ID records, with automatic account cancellation on failure.

- The platform has been used in 400+ academic studies.

Founder & Lead Developer — Openasy (open source)
Sep 2026 – Present | github.com/openasy

- Building an open-source (AGPL) security platform in TypeScript: VPN access management, vulnerability prioritisation, SAST/DAST/malware scanning agents, WAF (Coraza, OWASP CRS), Suricata-based network IDS and compliance evidence (ISO 27001, SOC 2, GDPR, PCI DSS); used in production at Mall IQ and YouReply.

Earlier Experience & Teaching

- **Software Engineer — CPE Link (Wolters Kluwer)**, Remote, Apr 2013 – Sep 2016: developed, maintained and tested www.cpelink.com and 25+ related projects; built the mobile version of the site when mobile web was still new, developed Learning Ladder and modernised Compliance Manager; led major bug-fixing and process-improvement efforts.
- **Lecturer (part-time) — Ankara Science University**, Jan 2024 – Jun 2026: taught Network Security, System Analysis & Design and Web Design & Development.
- **Software Engineer — Fikir Fabrikası**, Remote, 2011 – 2013 (20+ web projects) | **Backend Developer — Brew Interactive**, 2010 – 2011 (15+ client projects).

EDUCATION

PhD, Business Administration, Ankara University (Faculty of Political Science), 2026 – in progress

MSc, Production and Operations Management (with thesis), Hacettepe University, 2024 – 2026 (optimisation and decision analysis)

MBA, Hacettepe University, 2022 – 2024 (capstone: YouReply)

MSc, Software Management, Middle East Technical University (METU), 2015 – 2018 (Software Architecture, Secure Software Development, Security Engineering)

BSc, Aerospace Engineering, Middle East Technical University (METU), 2014

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Python, PHP, SQL, Bash

Backend & APIs: Node.js, Express.js, NestJS, REST, GraphQL, WebSocket, Swagger/OpenAPI, webhooks; Python (FastAPI); PHP (Laravel, Symfony)

Frontend: React, Next.js, Angular

AI: OpenAI API integrations in production; AI-assisted engineering (Claude, GitHub Copilot)

Data: MySQL (Oracle certified; replication, read replicas), PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Cassandra; Apache Airflow

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, CloudWatch, Redshift), Azure, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Ansible, Linux

Quality & SRE: Jest, Mocha, Cypress, Selenium, load testing; Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, Opsgenie, on-call

Security: Keycloak, OAuth2, SAML, SSO, GitHub Advanced Security, penetration-test remediation, ISO 27001, SOC 2

CERTIFICATIONS & LANGUAGES

Oracle Certified Professional, MySQL 5.6 Developer (2015) | Zend Certified Engineer, PHP 5.3 (2012)

Turkish — native | English — fluent | German — beginner